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PERSONAL STATEMENT

Dongxiao Zhu’s recent research interests are in Trustworthy AI with applications in health, urban, and social computing with emphasis on adversarial robustness, explainability, safety, security, and ethics. Dr. Zhu receives his PhD degree from University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, in 2006. Currently he is the **Founding Director** of [Wayne AI Research Lab](#), **Director** of the [Institute for AI and Data Science](#), and Director of [Trustworthy AI Lab](#) at Wayne State University. Previously he was the **Founder and Inaugural Program Director** of Master Program in AI, and **Director** of Graduate Program in Computer Science at Wayne State University. He has published over 100 peer-reviewed publications and served on program committees (Area Chair, Senior PC or PC) of flagship AI conferences (NuerIPS, ICML, ICLR, AAAI, IJCAI, ACL, EMNLP, CVPR, ECCV, AMIA, MICCAI) and of premier biomedical informatics journals (*Bioinformatics*, *Nucleic Acids Research*, *Journal of Computational Biology*, *Medical Physics*, *Journal of Medical Internet Research*, *BMC Genomics*, and *Frontiers in Genetics*). Alongside **foundational AI research**, Dr. Zhu also pursues **use-inspired AI research** in life, physical and social science domains. He is passionate about leveraging AI for science and social good. And his recent work in developing robust, fair and explainable AI algorithms and systems to ameliorate spatiotemporal mismatch between housing and employment, future of work, and reducing health disparities, just to name a few, manifesting his continuous efforts in achieving the sustainable development goals such as zero hunger, better cyber-social behaviors, good health and well-being, and reduced inequalities in socially vulnerable regions/groups. Dr. Zhu is also deeply engaged in **AI education**. As the program’s **Founder** and **Inaugural Director**, he led the efforts to launch Wayne State’s M.S. in AI, regularly teaches foundational AI courses, and actively leads initiatives to **increase AI literacy among faculty and students**, ensuring that the benefits of AI scholarship and practice extend across disciplines.

PRIMARY RESEARCH AREAS

Foundational Trustworthy AI: robustness, interpretability, safety, security, privacy, and fairness of foundation models, including LLMs, LVLMs, and LRMs
Use-Inspired AI and Data Science: grounding and stress-testing these methods in high-stakes settings: clinical data (EHR; CXR/CT/MRI/PET), genome and transcriptome sequencing, legal text, social media, and geospatial analysis

EMPLOYMENTS

Professor of Computer Science, Wayne State University	Aug 2023 – Present
Assistant/Associate Professor of Computer Science, Wayne State University	2011 – 2023
Assistant Professor of Computer Science, University of New Orleans	Jan 2008 – August 2011
Biostatistician, Stowers Institute for Medical Research, Kansas City, MO	June 2006 – December 2007

SELECTED LEADERSHIP ROLES AND SERVICE

- **Director** [Institute for AI and Data Science](#), WSU 2025–Present
- **Founding Director** [Wayne AI Research Lab](#), WSU 2021–Present
- **Founder and Inaugural Program Director: Algorithm and Software track** [Master Program in AI](#), WSU (ranked #18 nationally, TechGuide 2024) 2022–2024
- **Program Director** [Computer Science Graduate Program](#), WSU 2018–2020, 2022–2024
- **Chair, Computer Science Faculty Search Committee**, WSU 2021–2022, 2023–2024
- **College of Engineering Representative, University Faculty Senate**, WSU 2023–2026
- **Computer Science Representative, College of Engineering Faculty Assembly Executive Committee**, WSU 2025–Present

NSF/NIH RESEARCH AWARDS. TOTAL ~12 MILLION, AS PI ~9 MILLION.

NSF/EEC 2525266, “*Track 2: Collaborative Research: Supporting Engineering Retention with Veteran Empowerment through AI-supported Mentoring*”, Total: \$400,000, 2026 – 2029, **Role: Co-PI**, 25%.

NAIRR/260014, “*Aligning Large Reasoning Models via Safety-aware Post-Training*”, Total: \$10,000 Token Credit, 25,000 GPU Hours, 2026 – 2027, **Role: PI**, 100%.

NSF/IIS 2504264, “*Collaborative Research: III: Medium: Advancing Large Language Model Unlearning: Foundations and Applications*”, Total: \$800,000, 2025 – 2029, **Role: PI**, 33%.

NIH/R61/R331EY037504, “*VisionWay: Accessibility-aware Path Selection for Wayfinding*”, Total: \$2,700,000, 2025 – 2030, **Role: MPI**, 25%.

HRSA/5U1QHP53070, “*A.G.R.E.E.D. (Applied Gerontology Research and Education to Eliminate Disparities)-GWEP*”, Total: \$5,000,000, 2024 – 2029, **Role: Co-I**, 10%.

NIH/R33HD105610 “*Severity Predictors Integrating salivary Transcriptomics and proteomics with Multi neural network Intelligence in SARS-CoV2 infection in Children (SPITS MISC)*”, Total Amount: \$1,449,684, 2023 – 2025, **Role: MPI**, 33%.

NSF/ITE 2235225, “*NSF Convergence Accelerator Track H: Leveraging Human-Centered AI Microtransit to Ameliorate Spatiotemporal Mismatch between Housing and Employment for Persons with Disabilities*”. Total amount: \$613,621, 2022-2024, **Role: PI**, 25%.

NSF/IIS 2211897, “*Collaborative Research: HCC: Small: Understanding Online-to-Offline Sexual Violence through Data Donation from Users*”, Total Amount: \$600,000, 2022 – 2026, **Role: PI**, 33%.

NIH/R61HD105610, “*Severity Predictors Integrating salivary Transcriptomics and proteomics with Multi neural network Intelligence in SARS-CoV2 infection in Children (SPITS MISC)*”, Total Amount: \$1,433,469, 2021 – 2023, **Role: MPI**, 33%.

NSF/CNS 2043611, “*SCC-CIVIC-PG Track A: Leveraging AI-assist Microtransit to Ameliorate Spatiotemporal Mismatch between Housing and Employment.*”, Total Amount: \$49,898, 2021, **Role: PI**, 25%.

NSF/CNS 1724227, “*S&AS: INT: Autonomous Battery Operating System (ABOS): An Adaptive and Comprehensive Approach to Efficient, Safe, and Secure Battery System Management.*”, Total Amount: \$1,249,998, 2017-2021, **Role: Senior Personnel**, 10%.

NSF/CNS 1637312, “*S&CC: Promoting a Healthier Urban Community: Prioritization of Risk Factors for the Prevention and Treatment of Pediatric Obesity.*”, Total Amount: \$199,996, 2016-2018, **Role: co-PI**, 33%.

NSF/CCF 1451316, “*EAGER: A novel algorithmic framework for discovering subnetworks from big biological data.*”, Total Amount: \$179,989, 2014-2016, **Role PI**, 100%.

NIH/R21LM010137, “*A new informatics paradigm for reconstructing signaling pathways in human disease.*”, Total Amount: \$440,989, 2009-2011, **Role: PI**, 100%.

NSF/CCF 0939108, “*CPATH: A verification based learning model that enriches CS and related undergraduate programs.*”, Total Amount: \$300,000, 2009-2012, **Role: co-PI**, 25%.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Full publications can be found at [Google Scholar](#)

† my PhD students as the first author.

Foundational AI Research

- [1] C. Li, Q. He, D. N. Rusu, R. I. Sultan†, A. Lavrova, A. Doemer, E. A. Mellon, **D. Zhu**, and K. S. Thind, “PRIORADAPT: A Design Space for Reliability-Aware Prior Conditioning in Medical Image Segmentation,” under review.

- [2] M. S. A. Chowdhury[†], R. I. Sultan[†], and **D. Zhu**, “Knowing Where to Draw the Line: Privacy Boundary Reasoning in Large Vision-Language Models,” under review.
- [3] H. Zhu[†], S. Zare Zade[†], R. I. Sultan[†], D. Pan, and **D. Zhu**, “BOS Summary: The First Token Matters,” under review.
- [4] A. Sarker[†], R. I. Sultan[†], H. Zhu[†], **D. Zhu**, and P. Khanduri, “[Hallucination Mitigation for Large Vision Language Models via Implicit Feature Stabilization](#),” under review.
- [5] R. I. Sultan[†], X. Zhou, M. S. A. Chowdhury, C. Li, P. Khanduri, M. Brocanelli, and **D. Zhu**, “[SpatialCORE: Confidence-Aware Grounded Spatial Reasoning in Large Vision-Language Models](#),” under review.
- [6] R. I. Sultan[†], M. S. A. Chowdhury, S. Z. Zade, C. Li, P. Khanduri, M. Brocanelli, and **D. Zhu**, “[Soft Spatial Reasoning](#),” under review.
- [7] X. Zhou[†], S. Z. Zade, and **D. Zhu**, “[Alignment of LRMs via Counter-Aligned Few-Shot Conversation Exposure](#),” under review.
- [8] Y. Qiang[†], X. Zhou, and **D. Zhu**, “[Learning to Poison Large Language Models During Instruction Tuning](#),” under review.
- [9] A. Sarker[†], N. Shah[†], R. I. Sultan[†], R. Jang, **D. Zhu**, and P. Khanduri, “[Partition-Aware Unlearning for Removing Spurious Correlations in Large Vision-Language Models](#),” NeurIPS-26 (Evaluations and Datasets Track).
- [10] X. Zhou[†], S. Z. Zade, R. I. Sultan, A. Kotov, and **D. Zhu**, “[Towards Mitigating Deceptive Safety Alignment in Large Reasoning Models](#).” NeurIPS-26.
- [11] Y. Qiang[†], X. Zhou, **D. Zhu**, “[Hijacking Large Language Models via Adversarial In-Context Learning](#).” ECML-26.
- [12] P. Khanduri, C. Li, R. Sultan, Y. Qiang, J. Kliewer, **D. Zhu**, “[FedDRO: Federated Compositional Optimization for Distributionally Robust Learning](#).” TMLR-26.
- [13] R. I. Sultan[†], H. Zhu, C. Li, and **D. Zhu**, “[MedPlex: Deep Vision-Language Co-Adaptation for Clinically Grounded Medical Segmentation](#),” BMVC-26.
- [14] R. I. Sultan[†], H. Zhu, C. Li, and **D. Zhu**, “[WalkGPT: Grounded Vision-Language Conversation with Depth-Aware Segmentation for Pedestrian Navigation](#).” CVPR-26.
- [15] S. Z. Zade[†], X. Zhou[†], S. Liu, and **D. Zhu**, “[Attention Smoothing Is All You Need For Unlearning](#),” ICLR-26.
- [16] X. Zhou[†], Y. Qiang, S. Z. Zade, D. Zytco, P. Khanduri, and **D. Zhu**, “[Not All Tokens Are Meant to Be Forgotten](#),” AAAI-26 Oral.
- [17] S. Z. Zade[†], Y. Qiang, X. Zhou, H. Zhu, M. A. Roshani, P. Khanduri, and **D. Zhu**, “[Automatic Calibration for Membership Inference Attack on Large Language Models](#),” ECAI-25.
- [18] R. Sultan[†], C. Li, H. Zhu, P. Khanduri, M. Brocanelli, and **D. Zhu**, “[GeoSAM: Fine-tuning SAM with Multi-Modal Prompts for Mobility Infrastructure Segmentation](#),” ECAI-25.
- [19] E. Walquist, I. Datey, W. Zheng, X. Zhou, K. Berishaj, M. McDonald, M. Parkhill, **D. Zhu**, and D. Zytco, “[Collective Consent: Who Needs to Consent to the Donation of Data Representing Multiple People?](#),” CSCW-25.
- [20] C. Li[†], H. Zhu, R. I. Sultan, P. Khanduri, Y. Qiang, I. Chetty, K. Thind, and **D. Zhu**, “[MulModSeg: Enhancing Unpaired Multi-Modal Medical Image Segmentation with Modality-Conditioned Text Embedding and Alternating Training](#),” WACV-25.
- [21] C. Li[†], P. Khanduri, Y. Qiang, R. Sultan, I. Chetty, and **D. Zhu**, “[AutoProSAM: Automated Prompting SAM for 3D Multi-Organ Segmentation](#),” WACV-25.

- [22] Y. Qiang[†], C. Li, P. Khanduri, and **D. Zhu**, “Fairness-aware Vision Transformer via Debaised Self-Attention.” ECCV-24.
- [23] M. Zamiri, Y. Qiang[†], F. Nikolaev, **D. Zhu**, and A. Kotov, “Benchmark and Neural Architecture for Conversational Entity Retrieval from a Knowledge Graph,” TheWebConf-24.
- [24] W. Zhang, E. Walquist, I. Datey, X. Zhou, K. Berishaj, M. MacDonald, M. Parkhill, **D. Zhu**, D. Zytke, “Traumatic Data: Applying Trauma-Informed Design to Data Donation of Sexual Violence Experiences to Improve Sexual Risk Detection AI.” CHI-24.
- [25] Y. Qiang[†], C. Li, P. Khanduri, **D. Zhu**, “Interpretability-Aware Vision Transformer.” IJCNN-24.
- [26] Z. Zhu, H. Chen, J. Zhang, X. Wang, Z. Jin, M. Xue, **D. Zhu**, R. Cho, “MFABA: A More Faithful and Accelerated Boundary-based Attribution Method for Deep Neural Networks.” AAAI-24.
- [27] C. Li[†], R. Sultan, Y. Qiang, and **D. Zhu**, “FocalUNETR: A Focal Transformer for Boundary-aware Segmentation of CT Images.” MICCAI-23.
- [28] X. Li[†], D. Pan, C. Li, Y. Qiang, and **D. Zhu**, “Negative Flux Aggregation to Estimate Feature Attributions.” IJCAI-23.
- [29] X. Li[†], X. Li, D. Pan, Y. Qiang, and **D. Zhu**, “Learning Compact Features via In-Training Representation Alignment.” AAAI-23.
- [30] Y. Qiang[†], D. Pan, C. Li, X. Li, R. Jang, and **D. Zhu**, “AttCAT: Explaining Transformers via Attentive Class Activation Tokens.” NuerIPS-22.
- [31] Y. Qiang[†], C. Li, M. Brocanelli, and **D. Zhu**, “Counterfactual Interpolation Augmentation (CIA): A Unified Approach to Enhance Fairness and Explainability of DNN.” IJCAI-22.
- [32] Y. Qiang[†], TS. Supriya, Kumar, M. Brocanelli, and **D. Zhu**, “Tiny RNN Model with Certified Robustness for Text Classification.” IJCNN-22 (oral presentation).
- [33] C. Li[†], Zheng, Dong, N. Fisher, and **D. Zhu**, “Coupling User Preference with External Rewards to Enable Driver-centered and Resource-aware EV Charging Recommendation.” ECML-22.
- [34] D. Pan[†], X. Li, and **D. Zhu**, “Explaining deep neural network models with adversarial gradient integration.” IJCAI-21.
- [35] X. Li[†], X. Li, D. Pan, and **D. Zhu**, “Improving adversarial robustness via probabilistically compact loss with logit constraints.” AAAI-21.
- [36] L. Wang[†] and **D. Zhu**, “Tackling ordinal regression problem for heterogeneous data: sparse and deep multi-task learning approaches. *Data Mining and Knowledge Discovery*.” pp. 1–28, 2021.
- [37] D. Pan[†], X. Li, X. Li, and **D. Zhu**, “Explainable recommendation via interpretable feature mapping and evaluation of explainability.” IJCAI-20.
- [38] X. Li[†], X. Li, D. Pan, and **D. Zhu**, “On the learning property of logistic and softmax losses for deep neural networks.” AAAI-20.
- [39] Y. Qiang[†], X. Li, and **D. Zhu**, “Toward tag-free aspect based sentiment analysis: A multiple attention network approach.” IJCNN-20.
- [40] L. Wang[†], Y. Li, J. Zhou, **D. Zhu**, and J. Ye, “Multi-task survival analysis.” ICDM-17.
- [41] X. Li[†] and **D. Zhu**, “Robust feature selection via l2, 1-norm in finite mixture of regression.” *Pattern Recognition Letters*, vol. 108, pp. 15–22, 2018.
- [42] X. Li[†], **D. Zhu**, and M. Dong, “Multinomial classification with class-conditional overlapping sparse feature groups.” *Pattern Recognition Letters*, vol. 101, pp. 37–43, 2018.

- [43] L. Wang[†], **D. Zhu**, and M. Dong, “Clustering over-dispersed data with mixed feature types.” *Statistical Analysis and Data Mining: The ASA Data Science Journal*, vol. 11, no. 2, pp. 55–65, 2018.

Use-Inspired AI Research

- [44] R. I. Sultan[†], C. Li, Y. Demetriou, A. I. Ghanem, J. P. Kim, J. Cunningham, H. Bagher-Ebadian, **D. Zhu**, and K. S. Thind, “A Neighborhood Attention Transformer Network for Enhanced 3D Segmentation of the Left Anterior Descending Artery,” *Medical Physics*, accepted, 2026.
- [45] C. Li, D. Rusu, R. I. Sultan[†], H. Bagher-Ebadian, A. Doemer, **D. Zhu**, P. J. Parikh, and K. Thind, “Cross-Fraction Prior Learning for Scalable Organ-at-Risk Segmentation in Abdominal MR-Guided Radiotherapy,” *Medical Physics*, 2026.
- [46] U. Mgbogh[†], R. I. Sultan, J. Kim, K. Thind, and **D. Zhu**, “Robustness of Transformer-Based Fluence Map Prediction Under Clinically Realistic Perturbations,” *24th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence in Medicine*, 2026 (AIME-26).
- [47] U. Mgbogh[†], R. I. Sultan, J. Kim, K. Thind, and **D. Zhu**, “FluenceFormer: Transformer-Driven Multi-Beam Fluence Map Regression for Radiotherapy Planning,” *Medical Imaging with Deep Learning*, 2026 (MIDL-26).
- [48] C. Li[†], R. I. Sultan, H. BagherEbadian, Y. Qiang, K. Thind, **D. Zhu**, and I. J. Chetty, “Enhancing CT Image Segmentation Accuracy through Ensemble Loss Function Optimization,” *Medical Physics*, 2025.
- [49] K. Hilai, D. Grubich, M. Akrawi, H. Zhu, R. Zaghoul, C. Shi, M. Do, **D. Zhu**, and J. Zhang, “Mechanical Evolution of Metastatic Cancer Cells in 3D Microenvironment,” *Small*, 2025.
- [50] M. A. Roshani[†], X. Zhou, Y. Qiang, S. Suresh, S. Hicks, U. Sethuraman, and **D. Zhu**, “Generative Large Language Model—Powered Conversational AI App for Personalized Risk Assessment: Case Study in COVID-19,” *JMIR AI*, 2025.
- [51] M. Peivandi, J. Zhang, M. Lu, C. Li, **D. Zhu**, and Z. Kou, “Evaluation of the Segment Anything Model (SAM) for Brain Tumor Segmentation,” in *IEEE International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI) 2024*, IEEE Computer Society, 2024, pp. 1–4.
- [52] R. Manwar[†], X. Li, K. Kratkiewicz, **D. Zhu**, and K. Avanaki, “Adaptive coherent weighted averaging algorithm for enhancement of photoacoustic tomography images of brain,” *Journal of Biophotonics*, 2023.
- [53] C. Li[†], Bagher, HE, Sultan, RI, Elshaikh, M, Movsas, B, **D. Zhu**, and I, Chetty, “A new architecture combining convolutional and transformer-based networks for automatic 3D multi-organ segmentation on CT images,” *Medical Physics*, 2023.
- [54] W. Zheng, E. Walquist, I. Datey, X. Zhou, K. Berishaj, M. McDonald, M. Parkhill, **D. Zhu**, and D. Zytke, “Towards Trauma-Informed Data Donation of Sexual Experience in Online Dating to Improve Sexual Risk Detection AI,” in *Adjunct Proceedings of the 36th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST '23)*, ACM, 2023, Article 39:1–39:3.
- [55] R. Kabir[†], Remias, S, Wadell, J, and **D. Zhu** “Time-Series fuel consumption prediction assessing delay impacts on energy using vehicular trajectory,” *Transportation Research*, 117, 103678, 2022.
- [56] X. Li[†], Bagher, HE, Kim, J, **D. Zhu**, and I, Chetty, “An uncertainty-aware deep learning architecture with outlier mitigation for prostate gland segmentation in radiotherapy treatment planning,” *Medical Physics*, 50(1), 311–322, 2022.
- [57] X. Li[†], J. Hect, M. Thomason, and **D. Zhu**, “Interpreting age effects of human fetal brain from spontaneous fmri using deep 3d convolutional neural networks.” in *2020 IEEE 17th International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI)*. IEEE, 2020, pp. 1424–1427.

- [58] X. Li[†], **D. Zhu**, and P. D. Levy, “Predicting clinical outcomes with patient stratification via deep mixture neural networks.” *AMIA Summits on Translational Science Proceedings*, vol. 2020, p. 367, 2020.
- [59] X. Li[†], J. Hect, M. Thomason, and **D. Zhu**, “Interpreting age effects of human fetal brain from spontaneous fmri using deep 3d convolutional neural networks.” in *2020 IEEE 17th International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI)*. IEEE, 2020, pp. 1424–1427.
- [60] X. Li[†], R. Cao, and **D. Zhu**, “Vispi: Automatic visual perception and interpretation of chest x-rays.” in *International Conference on Medical Imaging with Deep Learning: MIDL 2020*. IEEE, 2020.
- [61] X. Li[†], C. Li, and **D. Zhu**, “Covid-mobilexpert: On-device covid-19 patient triage and follow-up using chest x-rays.” in *2020 IEEE International Conference on Bioinformatics and Biomedicine (BIBM)*. IEEE, 2020, pp. 1063–1067.
- [62] X. Li[†], D. Pan[†], and **D. Zhu**, “Defending against adversarial attacks on medical imaging ai system, classification or detection?” in *2021 IEEE 18th International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI)*. IEEE, 2021.
- [63] X. Li[†] and **D. Zhu**, “Robust detection of adversarial attacks on medical images.” in *2020 IEEE 17th International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI)*. IEEE, 2020, pp. 1154–1158.
- [64] M. Z. Nezhad[†], N. Sadati, K. Yang, and **D. Zhu**, “A deep active survival analysis approach for precision treatment recommendations: Application of prostate cancer.” *Expert Systems with Applications*, vol. 115, pp. 16–26, 2019.
- [65] L. Wang[†], M. Dong, E. Towner, and **D. Zhu**, “Prioritization of multi-level risk factors for obesity.” in *2019 IEEE International Conference on Bioinformatics and Biomedicine (BIBM)*. IEEE, 2019.
- [66] X. Li[†], **D. Zhu**, and P. D. Levy, “Leveraging auxiliary measures: a deep multi-task neural network for predictive modeling in clinical research.” *BMC medical informatics and decision making*, vol. 18, no. 4, p. 126, 2018.
- [67] L. Wang[†], **D. Zhu**, E. Towner, and M. Dong, “Obesity risk factors ranking using multi-task learning.” in *Biomedical & Health Informatics (BHI), 2018 IEEE EMBS International Conference on*. IEEE, 2018, pp. 385–388.
- [68] X. Li[†], **D. Zhu**, M. Dong, M. Z. Nezhad, A. Janke, and P. D. Levy, “Sdt: A tree method for detecting patient subgroups with personalized risk factors.” *AMIA Summits on Translational Science Proceedings*, vol. 2017, p. 193, 2017.
- [69] M. Z. Nezhad[†], **D. Zhu**, N. Sadati, K. Yang, and P. Levi, “Subic: A supervised bi-clustering approach for precision medicine.” in *2017 16th IEEE International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA)*. IEEE, 2017, pp. 755–760.
- [70] X. Li[†], **D. Zhu**, and P. Levy, “Predictive deep network with leveraging clinical measure as auxiliary task.” in *2017 IEEE International Conference on Bioinformatics and Biomedicine (BIBM)*. IEEE, 2017, pp. 786–791.
- [71] L. Wang[†], **D. Zhu**, M. Dong, and Y. Li, “Modeling over-dispersion for network data clustering.” in *Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA), 2017 16th IEEE International Conference on*. IEEE, 2017, pp. 42–49.
- [72] M. Z. Nezhad[†], **D. Zhu**, X. Li, K. Yang, and P. Levy, “Safs: A deep feature selection approach for precision medicine.” in *Bioinformatics and Biomedicine (BIBM), 2016 IEEE International Conference on*. IEEE, 2016, pp. 501–506.

- [73] M. Li, X. Zhou, **D. Zhu**, J. Wu, and C. Fan, [Unraveling Salt-Responsive Genes in Suaeda salsa through Genomic and Transcriptomic Profiling across Salinity Gradients](#),” *BMC Genomics*, In Press.
- [74] D. Uprety, **D. Zhu**, and H. West, [ChatGPT—A promising generative AI tool and its implications for cancer care](#),” *Cancer*, vol. 129, no. 15, pp. 2284–2289, 2023.
- [75] S. Hicks, **D. Zhu**, R. Sullivan, and U. Sethuraman. “[Saliva microRNA Profile in Children with and without Severe SARS-CoV-2 Infection](#),” *International Journal of Molecular Sciences*, 24(9), p.8175, 2023.
- [76] C. Li[†], R. Sullivan, **D. Zhu**, and S. Hicks. “[Putting the ‘mi’ in omics: discovering miRNA biomarkers for pediatric precision care](#),” *Pediatrics Research*, <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41390-022-02206-5>, 2022.
- [77] L. Wang[†], L., Acharya, C. Bai, and **D. Zhu**. “[Transcriptome assembly strategies for precision medicine](#).” *Quantitative Biology*, pp 1-11, <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40484-017-0109-2>.
- [78] L. Wang[†], **D. Zhu**, Li, Y and Dong, M. “[Poisson-Markov Mixture Model and Parallel Algorithm for Binning Massive and Heterogeneous DNA Sequencing Reads](#).” In the Series of Lecture Notes in Computer Science (ISBRA 2016).
- [79] Hou, J., Acharya, L.[†], **D. Zhu**, and Chen, J. [An overview of bioinformatics methods for modeling biological pathways in yeast](#). *Briefings in Functional Genomics*, 15(2), 95-108, 2016.
- [80] **D. Zhu**, Deng, N[†], and Bai C[†]. “[A Generalized dSpliceType Framework to Detect Differential Splicing and Differential Expression Events Using RNA-Seq](#).” *IEEE Transaction on NanoBio-Science*, DOI: 10.1109/TNB.2015.2388593, 2016.
- [81] Deng, N[†] and **D. Zhu**, “[dSpliceType: a multivariate model for detecting various types of differential splicing events using RNA-Seq](#).” in the proceedings of 2014 International Symposium on Bioinformatics Research and Applications (ISBRA’14).
- [82] Deng, N[†], Sanchez, C, Lasky, J, and **D. Zhu**, “[Detecting splicing variants from non-differentially expressed genes of human idiopathic pulmoary fibrosis](#).” *PLoS One* 8(7):e68352. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0068352, 2013.
- [83] Judeh, T[†], Johnson, C, Kumar, A, and **D. Zhu**, “[TEAK: Topological Enrichment Analysis framework for detecting activated biological subpathways](#).” *Nucleic Acids Res.*, doi: 10.1093/nar/gks1299. 2013.
- [84] Deng, N[†] and **D. Zhu**, “[Detecting various types of differential splicing events using RNA-Seq data](#).” in the proceedings of 2013 ACM Conference on Bioinformatics, Computational Biology and Biomedicine (ACM BCB’13).
- [85] Nguyen, T[†] and **D. Zhu**, “[MarkovBin: An Algorithm to Cluster Metagenomic Reads Using a Mixture Modeling of Hierarchical Distributions](#).” in the proceedings of 2013 ACM Conference on Bioinformatics, Computational Biology and Biomedicine (ACM BCB’13).
- [86] Judeh, T[†], Jayyousi T, Reynolds, B and **D. Zhu**, “[Gene Set Cultural Algorithm: A Cultural Algorithm Approach to Reconstruct Networks from Gene Sets](#).” in the proceedings of 2013 ACM Conference on Bioinformatics, Computational Biology and Biomedicine (ACM BCB’13).
- [87] Acharya, L[†], Judeh, T, Wang, G, and **D. Zhu**, “[Optimal structural inference of signaling pathways from overlapping and unordered gene sets](#).” *Bioinformatics*, doi 10.1093/bioinformatics/btr696, 28(4), 546-556, 2012
- [88] Judeh, T[†], Nguyen, T and **D. Zhu**, “[QSEA for fuzzy subgraph querying of KEGG pathways](#).” in the proceedings of 2012 ACM Conference on Bioinformatics, Computational Biology and Biomedicine (ACM BCB’12).

- [89] Acharya, L[†], Judeh, T, Duan, Z, Rabbat, M, and **D. Zhu**, “[GSGS: A computational framework for reconstructing signaling pathways from gene sets.](#)” *IEEE/ACM transaction on Computational Biology and Bioinformatics (TCBB)*, 9(2), 438-450, 2011.
- [90] Deng N[†], Puetter, A, Zhang, K, Johnson, K., Zhao, Z, Taylor, C, Flemington, E and **D. Zhu**, “[Isoform-level microRNA-155 Target Prediction using RNA-seq.](#)” *Nucleic Acids Res.*, doi: 10.1093/nar/gkr042, 2011.
- [91] Xu G[†], Deng N, Zhao, Z, Flemington EK, and **D. Zhu**, “[SAMMate: A GUI tool for processing short read alignment information in SAM/BAM format.](#)” *Source Code for Biology and Medicine*, 6:2, 2011.
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ACADEMIC SERVICE

- **Conference Organization:** Program Co-Chair, *IEEE International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA)*, Rochester, MI, 2026; Vice Program Co-Chair, *IEEE International Conference on Big Data (IEEE BigData)*, Phoenix, AZ, 2026
- **Workshop Co-Organizer:** *AdvML-Frontiers × CoTMA @ COLM* 2026; *Workshop on Adversarial Machine Learning Frontiers @ NeurIPS* 2024, *ICML* 2023, *ICML* 2022
- **Area Chair:** *NeurIPS* 2025, 2026; *ICLR* 2027. **Senior PC / Meta-Reviewer:** *AAAI* 2024, 2026, 2027; *IJCAI* 2023, 2024, 2025; *IJCAI-ECAI* 2026. **Program Committee:** *ICML*, *CVPR*, *ECCV*, *ACL*, *EMNLP*, *MICCAI*, *AMIA*. **Gold Reviewer Award**, *ICML* 2026
- **Grant Review Panels:** NIH CSR Clinical Informatics and Digital Health (CIDH) Study Section, 2026; diverse NIH study sections, 20+ times, 2011–2026; NSF CISE panels, 6 times, 2024–2026; DOE review panel, 2025
- **Editorial Service:** Editorial Board, *BMC Genomics* and *Frontiers in Genetics*; Topic Editor, *Frontiers in Genetics*, “Evolution in Statistical Genetics and Methodology,” 2023

COMMUNITY, INDUSTRY, AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- **AI Fellowship Program**, Co-Developer, with WSU Tech Ramp; AI fellow training program for technology careers, funded by the *Rocket Community Fund* (\$550,000) 2026–Present
- **AI-Ready Michigan Workforce Training Hub**, Lead; led a statewide AI workforce-training coalition and its NSF TechAccess proposal as PI, a WSU-led consortium with U-M, MSU, MTU, and GVSU and 26 public- and private-sector partners 2026
- **AI Infrastructure Hub for Michigan**, Co-Leader; one of Michigan’s leaders in AI infrastructure 2026
- **Public Lecture on AI Literacy**, *AI and Ethics Lecture Series*, Royal Oak Public Library, Royal Oak, MI Feb 2026

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Bioinformatics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	2006
M.A. in Statistics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	2005
M.A. in Math concentration on Computer Science, Eastern Michigan University , Ypsilanti	2002
M.S. in Microbiology, Peking University , Beijing, China	1999
B.S. in Microbiology, Shandong University , Jinan, China	1996

PRESS COVERAGE

- **New America:** *Making AI Work for the Public: An ALT Perspective* (interviewee) Nov 2025
- **Detroit PBS:** *AI for Mobility Project Seeks to Improve Detroit’s Public Transit System* Mar 2024
- **Hour Detroit:** *How AI Changes the Future of Medicine* Oct 2022
- **DBusiness:** *AI to Bring Micro-transit to Hourly Workers* Feb 2021
- **EurekAlert:** *AI to Aid Early Detection of SARS-CoV2 in Children* Feb 2021
- **Scientific American:** *AI-Assisted Diagnosis* Feb 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- *CSC 5991 Trustworthy AI for LLMs and VLMs* Winter 2026
- *CSC 5825 Introduction to Machine Learning and Applications* Winter 2017; Fall 2017–2024
- *CSC 7825 Machine Learning* Winter 2019–2022
- *CSC 8800 Seminars in Machine Learning and AI* Winter 2021–2023
- *CSC 8860 Seminars in Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition* Fall 2017
- *CSC 8890 Graduate Seminars in Computer Science* Fall 2025
- *CSC 6580 Design and Analysis of Algorithms* Winter 2015–2017
- *CSC 2110 Computer Science I* Winter 2012–2014

PHD STUDENT ADVISING

Recently Graduated PhD Students (12 graduated in total)

- **Ujunwa Mgbob**, Ph.D. 2026; now Tenure-Track Assistant Professor, University of Wisconsin–Green Bay
- **Yao Qiang**, Ph.D. 2024, *Designing for Reliability: Theoretical and Applied Perspectives on Trustworthy Artificial Intelligence*; now Tenure-Track Assistant Professor, Oakland University
- **Chengyin Li**, Ph.D. 2024, *Novel Transformer Architectures for 3D Multi-modal and Multi-organ Medical Image Segmentation*; now Staff Scientist, Henry Ford Health
- **Xin Li**, Ph.D. 2022, *Adversarial Machine Learning for Advanced Medical Imaging Systems*; now Research Scientist, Bosch Research
- **Deng Pan**, Ph.D. 2022, *Interpretable Machine Learning and Applications*; now Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Notre Dame

Current PhD Students: Xiangyu Zhou, Saleh Zare Zade, Rafi Ibn Sultan, Hui Zhu, Mohammad Amin Roshani, Mahbub Islam Mahim, Shou-Tzu Han, Yiannos Demetriou (MD/PhD)

Student Honors: Michael E. Conrad Award to Yao Qiang (2023) and Chengyin Li (2024); AMIA 2020 Best Student Paper Award to Xin Li

RECENT INVITED TALKS

- “Generative AI Interplay with Humanity and Society,” Invited Talk, **WSU Humanity Symposium** Mar 2026
- “Towards Trustworthy Foundation Models: From Precise Unlearning to Grounded Multimodal Reasoning,” Invited Talk, **University of Texas at Dallas** Feb 2026
- *AI in the Public Sector*, Invited Panelist, **Boston Consulting Group** Nov 2025
- *Data Science & AI Summit 2025*, Invited Panelist, **MSU Research Foundation** Oct 2025
- “Enhancing Algorithmic Fairness in Deep Learning: Discovering and Mitigating Spurious Features,” Invited Talk, **University of Alabama at Birmingham, School of Medicine** Oct 2024
- “Leveraging NAIRR for Enhancing Trustworthy AI,” Invited Talk, National AI Research Resource (NAIRR), **National Science Foundation** May 2024
- “Towards Trustworthy AGI in the Era of Foundation Models: Opportunities, Risks, and Vision,” Invited Talk, **National Science Foundation** Dec 2023
- “Enhancing Algorithmic Fairness in Deep Learning,” Invited Talk, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, **University at Buffalo** Apr 2023
- *Fairness in Machine Intelligence for Global Health* Workshop, Panelist Apr 2023
- “Advancing Algorithmic Fairness: Detecting and Fixing Spurious Patterns,” Invited Talk, Department of Statistics and Probability, **Michigan State University** Jan 2023
- “Empowering Explainable Machine Learning through the Lens of Adversarial Robustness and Fairness,” Invited Talk, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, **Michigan State University** Nov 2022
- *Workshop on Adversarial Machine Learning towards Advanced Vision Systems* (AMLAVS), Keynote Speech, **ACCV 2022** 2022
- “Robust and Explainable Machine Learning Algorithms for Social Good,” Invited Talk, Department of Computer and Data Sciences, **Case Western Reserve University** Nov 2021

HONORS AND RECOGNITION

- **ICML Gold Reviewer Award**, International Conference on Machine Learning 2026
- **Top Cited Article**, Journal of Biophotonics 2023
- **Excellence in Research Award**, College of Engineering, Wayne State University 2022
- **Excellence in Teaching Award**, College of Engineering, Wayne State University 2016
- **Top Cited Article**, Journal of Biophotonics, Wiley, for “Deep Learning Protocol for Improved Photoacoustic Brain Imaging” 2020–2021

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- **Best Student Paper Award**, AMIA Clinical Informatics Summit (first-authored by my PhD student) 2020
 - **Best Paper Award, Top-3 Finalist**, ICMLA 2017
 - **Best Poster Award, Top-3 Finalist**, ICMLA 2017